Brands Academy Nigeria Foundation Website Review

Nov 12, 2026 · @Godwin

Recommendations for corrections and amendments to make the site work better as a training platform.

1. Overall assessment

The site has a strong structure for a training institution: a three-tier certification pathway (CBA → CBS → CBE), application windows for each cohort, membership with digital IDs, credential verification, and a page for institutional partnerships. The design concept is sound.

In its current state, though, it reads as an **unfinished platform shell**. It has five main problems:

1. **Empty sections.** Five menu items (Short Courses, Webinars, Conferences, Journal, Community) open on pages that say "nothing found".
2. **Live bugs.** Dates and statuses contradict each other on the pages that matter most: the cohort application pages.
3. **Test data is visible to the public** in the Certified Practitioners Register.
4. **Claims of authority are unsupported** ("National Standard", "Official Statutory Register", "Accredited", "Cryptographically verified"). They could undermine credibility or create legal exposure.
5. **The domain does not match the brand.** The Foundation runs on *ecoenergy-ltd.com*, a name that suggests an unrelated, for-profit energy company.

A prospective learner, a university or a ministry evaluating the Foundation would notice most of these within a few minutes. Fixing them should come before any marketing push.

2. Critical fixes (do these first)

#	Issue found	Where	Recommended correction
1	**Domain mismatch.** The brand is Brands Academy Nigeria Foundation, but the site is ecoenergy-ltd.com.	Every page	Register a matching domain (e.g. *brandsacademy.org.ng* or *brandsacademy.ng*), move the site to it, and set up a 301 redirect from the old domain. Use the same domain for email (e.g. admissions@…).
2	**Countdown bug.** The CBA card says "Applications Open" but also "Application Window Closes 1 week 4 days **ago**". The deadline is 24 Nov 2026, which is still in the future. The	Home page, /workshops, CBA cohort page	The relative-time function adds "ago" to future dates. Fix it to show "Closes in 12 days" / "Opens in 6 days". Better still, show the fixed

#	Issue found	Where	Recommended correction
	CBS card says "Opens 5 days 23 hours **ago**" and also shows "Applications Closed".		date ("Closes 24 Nov 2026"). Make sure each card shows only one status.
3	**Status mismatch for the free Bootcamp.** It shows "Review in progress" on the home page but "Applications Closed" on /workshops.	Home, /workshops	Use one source of truth for cohort status.
4	**Test data in the Register.** Entries show nonsense strings ("dsfgdfggfdfgdfgfgd"). Some entries are badged "Verified" but show 0 credentials. One name looks misspelt ("Sani Shehsu", probably Shehu). An entry from Bayero University Kano is listed under Kaduna jurisdiction.	/registry	Delete all test records before launch. Check every live entry with the person concerned, and get their consent to be listed publicly. Only show "Verified" when the person actually holds a credential.
5	**Membership form validation shows contradictory states.** "Passwords Match" and "Mismatch" appear together, along with "Account Found" on a new registration, an empty "Did you mean ?" prompt, and "Ready to Submit" while errors remain.	/membership/register	Test the form end to end on desktop and mobile. Hide each validation message until the condition it describes actually applies.
6	**Calculator arithmetic is wrong.** ₦15,000 + ₦13,000 = ₦28,000 is labelled "25% Member Savings Included", yet a −₦7,000 discount is shown. With the discount applied, the total should be ₦21,000. The calculator's business-name figure (₦28,000) also differs from the ₦35,000 listed on the CAC & IP Desk page.	/services/calculator, /services/brand-ip-and-cac	Correct the formula and use one fee table for both pages.
7	**Cohort names are out of date.** "Cohort 2024-B" and "Cohort 2025-A" run from Nov 2026 to Feb 2027.	/workshops, cohort pages, URLs	Rename them, e.g. CBA Cohort 2026-1 and CBS Cohort 2026-1, and update the page addresses.

#	Issue found	Where	Recommended correction
8	**Registration number label is wrong.** The site shows "RC / IT No. 7344471". RC is the prefix for companies; an incorporated trustee uses IT.	Header and footer, all pages	Use "CAC/IT/No. 7344471" consistently (confirm the exact format against the CAC certificate).
9	**Outdated law cited.** The site cites "CAMA CAP C20 LFN 2004".	Footer, About	Cite the **Companies and Allied Matters Act 2020** (Part F, Incorporated Trustees).
10	**Timeline conflict.** The Board was "appointed at the AGM of 1 October 2023", but the Foundation was only incorporated on 12 February 2024.	/about	Reword, e.g. "Trustees nominated at the founding meeting of 1 October 2023 and confirmed on incorporation, 12 February 2024."

3. Claims that weaken credibility or create legal risk

A foundation that is less than three years old gains more trust from modest, verifiable claims than from grand, unsupported ones.

- **"The National Standard for Brand Governance…" (main home-page headline).** This implies official or regulatory status. Suggested replacement: *"Building Nigeria's Next Generation of Brand Professionals: Practical, Certified Training in Brand Strategy, Governance and Leadership."*
- **"Official Statutory Register of Certified Practitioners".** "Statutory" means the register was created by law, which it was not. Rename it *"BANF Register of Certified Brand Practitioners"*.
- **"Accredited" curricula and "internationally benchmarked standards".** No accrediting body or benchmark is named. Either name it (e.g. a recognised professional institute or a partner university) or remove the word.
- **"Cryptographically verified against the CAC IT 7344471 Registry".** CAC does not host your credentials, so this wording is misleading. Use: *"Verify any certificate or member ID issued by the Foundation against our official records."* Also drop the jargon ("Instant Vector Verification", "Cryptographic QR", "auto-minted").
- **Unnamed partners.** The site refers to "federal ministries" and "top African universities" without naming any. Name them, with their written permission and logos, or remove the claim.
- **Journal (JBSM).** The site calls it an "international, double-blind peer-reviewed quarterly", but it shows "ISSN Applied", no editorial board and no articles. Until Volume 1 is published, present it as *"Call for Papers: Inaugural Issue"*, with a named Editor-in-Chief and editorial board, author guidelines, the review process, any fees, and a submission deadline. Also check the name: "Journal of Brand Strategy" already exists internationally, so a more distinctive title (e.g. *Nigerian Journal of Brand Strategy & Management*) would avoid confusion.
- **CAC & Brand IP Desk.** This section carries the most risk. It claims an "Accredited Legal & IP Operations Desk" and "certified legal practitioners", and says an "official government

certificate" is issued, without naming an accredited CAC agent, a lawyer or a licence number. It collects ID uploads without a privacy notice. It also names the ministry two different ways. Recommendations:

- State clearly that filings are handled by **[named CAC-accredited agent / law firm, accreditation no.]** and that certificates are issued by CAC, the Trademarks Registry or NCC, not by the Foundation.
- Add disclaimers: the Foundation is not a law firm, registration outcomes are not guaranteed, and statutory fees are shown separately from service fees.
- Add refund and rejection terms and a data-protection notice (under the NDPA 2023) for uploaded IDs.
- Use the ministry's current name consistently: *Federal Ministry of Industry, Trade and Investment*.
- Consider moving this desk down the menu, or framing it as a partner service. As the second-most-prominent item on a training site, it blurs the not-for-profit educational identity.

4. Making it work as a training platform

4.1 Remove or fill the empty pages

Short Courses ("No courses found"), Webinars ("No upcoming webinars"), Conferences ("No Upcoming Summits"), Journal (no articles) and Community ("No discussions found") are all empty. Empty pages tell visitors the institution is inactive. For each one, either:

- **hide it from the menu** until it has real content, or
- **launch it with a minimum viable offer**, for example:
  - Short Courses: 2–3 short self-paced courses (e.g. *Introduction to Branding for SMEs*), one of them free as a lead magnet.
  - Webinars: a monthly free masterclass with a date, a named speaker and a registration form.
  - Conferences: a "Save the date" page for the 2027 Summit with an interest form.
  - Community: seed it with 5–10 moderated threads and publish community rules.

4.2 Simplify the navigation

The main menu has about 14 items, and labels differ between the desktop, mobile and footer menus (e.g. "Workshops Live" vs "Workshops & Cohorts Live"). Proposed structure:

Menu	Contains
Programmes	Certification Cohorts · Short Courses · Webinars & Masterclasses · Free Community Track
Certification	3-Tier Pathway (CBA / CBS / CBE) · Verify a Credential · Practitioners Register
Membership	Categories & fees · Benefits · Join / Renew

Menu	Contains
For Institutions	Staff training · Curriculum licensing · Sponsor a bootcamp
About	Mission & Manifesto · Trustees · Faculty · Governance documents
Resources	Journal · Conferences · Community
Buttons	**Apply Now** · Sign In

4.3 Complete each programme page

The CBA page has a good five-module syllabus, but a learner deciding whether to pay needs more. Add the following to **every** cohort page:

- **Learning outcomes:** 4–6 statements of what the learner will be able to do.
- **Schedule:** start **and end** date, days, times (WAT), total contact hours, and the format of each session.
- **Venue:** full address of the "Kaduna Training Centre" with a map, plus the platform used for online sessions (Zoom, Google Meet, the LMS).
- **Eligibility and prerequisites,** especially for CBS (Tier 2).
- **Assessment:** what is assessed, the pass mark, and the Distinction criteria.
- **Facilitators:** names, photos and short bios. The current "Industry Fellows (unnamed)" is not enough.
- **Fees:** what the fee covers (materials, certificate, lunch for in-person sessions), how to pay, the payment deadline, any instalment option, and the refund/deferral policy.
- **A sample certificate** and an **FAQ**.
- **CBE (Tier 3):** it appears in the pathway but has no programme page. Add a page, even if it says "Launching 2027: register interest".
- Give each certification tier **its own page**. At the moment the CBA, CBS, CBE and Free-Access links all go to the same /workshops page.

4.4 Payment and enrolment

- The training pages have no visible checkout or payment instructions. Integrate Paystack or Flutterwave into the application flow (the IP Desk already mentions Paystack/SquadCo). Also offer bank-transfer details and issue receipts automatically.
- Membership fees are not stated anywhere, yet members are promised a 25% discount. Publish a fee table by category (Student, Professional, Corporate, Fellow), with the renewal cycle and a comparison of benefits.
- Explain the **scholarship and subsidy criteria** and the **Free Community Track**: who qualifies, how to apply, and when decisions are made.
- Say when applicants will hear back ("Admission decisions within 5 working days of the closing date").

4.5 Faculty and trustees

- All four people shown use initials instead of photos, and three of the four have no institutional affiliation or qualifications listed. Add professional photos and full bios (qualifications, current appointment, years of experience, areas of expertise).
- The page is titled **Faculty & Trustees**, but no faculty or mentors appear. Add the facilitators who will actually teach the cohorts.
- Correct "fnimn" to **FNIMN** (Fellow, National Institute of Marketing of Nigeria) and spell out other post-nominals.
- The footer lists the Secretary among the "Board of Trustees"; the About page lists him as Secretary to the Board. Make the two consistent.
- Remove the stray "Postgraduate Dean Chair" label, or give it context.

4.6 Trust and contact signals

- Add a **phone number and WhatsApp line**. Most Nigerian enquiries come that way.
- Make the email address visibly readable (check that the Cloudflare email protection displays properly in browsers) and use a branded address.
- Add links to the **Privacy Policy, Terms of Use, Refund Policy and Code of Ethics**. The membership page asks users to agree to a "code of ethics and professional charter" that is not linked anywhere.
- Show the **CAC certificate** (or a verifiable reference) and a summary of the constitution on the About page.
- Add social media links and a Google Business Profile for the Kaduna office.
- As cohorts finish, add **real** testimonials, photos of sessions, and numbers trained. Keep the specimen certificate ("Chidi Okafor") clearly watermarked SPECIMEN so it is not mistaken for a real record.

4.7 Usability and performance

- Test on low-end Android phones over 3G/4G, since most learners will visit on mobile. Compress images and avoid heavy animation.
- Remove stray form text ("Valid" after fields, "Role set", "Country Set") and replace it with helpful placeholder hints.
- The membership form's Step 2 is called "Track Category & **State**", but it has no State field. Either add a State field (useful for Nigerian reporting) or rename the step.
- Make sure page titles and meta descriptions are unique on each page for search engines and social sharing.

5. Consistency and language

- **One name.** Use "Brands Academy Nigeria Foundation (BANF)" the first time it appears, then "the Foundation" or "BANF". Drop "Institutional Portal".
- **One spelling standard.** Use British/Nigerian English throughout. Change "Organizational" to "Organisational" and "Marginalized" to "Marginalised".
- **One scope statement.** Choose between "across Nigeria and beyond" and "across Nigeria and West Africa".

- **Define acronyms at first use:** CBA, CBS, CBE, JBSM, CPD, IP.
- **Plain language.** Replace tech jargon with words learners understand (e.g. "1-Click Cohort Application" → "Apply to any open cohort with your member login").
- **Align with the mission.** The constitution emphasises free training and support for marginalised communities. Give the Free Community Track and the scholarships more prominence on the home page, and the IP filing services less.

6. Suggested action plan

Phase	Timing	Actions
Fix	This week, before the CBA deadline of 24 Nov	Countdown and status bugs; delete Register test data; repair the membership form; correct the registration number, CAMA citation and cohort names; fix the calculator.
Clean up	Weeks 2–3	Hide empty sections; simplify the navigation; tone down the authority claims; add disclaimers, policies, contact phone and WhatsApp; add photos and bios for trustees and faculty.
Complete	Weeks 3–6	Full programme pages (outcomes, schedule, venue, assessment, facilitators, payment, refunds); membership fee table; scholarship criteria; CBE page; online payment.
Rebrand domain	Within 6 weeks	Move to a matching domain with redirects and branded email.
Grow	Ongoing	Launch the first short courses and monthly webinars; Journal call for papers with an editorial board; testimonials and impact figures; named partners.

7. Notes on this review

- Reviewed on 12 November 2026: Home, About, Faculty, Workshops, CBA cohort page, Short Courses, Webinars, CAC & IP Desk, Fee Calculator, Conferences, Journal, Community, Membership registration, Registry, Partnerships and Verify. Pages behind sign-in (member dashboard, transcripts) were not reviewed.
- The review was based on the text content of each page. A few items, such as menus appearing twice or metadata showing as text, may be how the pages were read rather than what visitors see. The web designer should confirm these in a normal browser before changing them.